

2 Objective C Basics

Objective-C is basically just an extension to the standard ANSI C language, except that it's an object-oriented programming language such as Java or C#. It's used primarily by Apple for programming Mac OS X and iPhone applications. If you're familiar with C, you'll find this easy to learn. At the same time, novices won't find this a horrendous task. The source code for any iPhone application is contained in two types of files – header files (.h) and implementation files (.m).

2.1 Preprocessor directives

Just as all your C and C++ include preprocessor directives use the `#include` statement, Objective-C files use `#import`. The top of your `BasicClass.h` file will contain the `#import` statement as follows:

```
#import < Foundation/Foundation.h >
@interface BasicClass : NSObject {
}
@end
```

The Objective-C compiler ensures that any header file is included at most only once. The syntax to import a header file from one of the framework APIs is to specify the header filename using angle brackets `< >` in the `#import` statement. If the header file is already within your project, modify the syntax to use double quotes (`" "`) instead of the angle brackets. For example, in the `BasicClass.m` file, we will import the `BasicClass.h` file as follows:

```
#import "BasicClass.h"
@implementation BasicClass
@end
```

Methods

All the functions that you define in a class are referred to as methods.

Classes

Most of time in object-oriented programming goes in dealing with different classes. In Objective-C, classes are declared using the `@interface` compiler directive:

```
@interface BasicClass : NSObject {
}
```